2026/2027	**Forsyth County Schools** **High School Course Syllabus** **Introduction to Software Technology** **Denmark High School**

Teacher Information

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Course Information

Course Description:	Introduction to Software Technology is the foundational course for Cloud Computing, Computer Science, Game Design, Internet of Things, Programming, Web and Digital Design, and Web Development pathways. This course is designed for high school students to understand, communicate, and adapt to a digital world as it impacts their personal life, society, and the business world. Exposure to foundational knowledge in programming languages, software development, app creation, and user interfacing applications are all taught in a computer lab with hands-on activities and project-focused tasks. Students will not only understand the concepts but apply their knowledge to situations and defend their actions, decisions, and/or choices through the knowledge and skills acquired in this course. Employability skills are integrated into activities, tasks, and projects throughout the course standards to demonstrate the skills required by business and industry. Competencies in the co-curricular student organizations are integral components of both the employability skills standards and content standards for this course. Various forms of technologies will be highlighted to expose students to the emerging technologies impacting the digital world. Professional communication skills and practices, problem solving, ethical and legal issues, and the impact of effective presentation skills are taught in this course as a foundational knowledge to prepare students to be college and career ready. The knowledge and skills taught in this course build upon each other to form a comprehensive introduction to the digital world. Introduction to Software Technology is a course that is appropriate for all high school students. The pre-requisite for this course is advisor approval.
Course Standards:	Standards with codeHS alignment
Pathway(s):	Introduction to Software Technology is the foundational course for the Cloud Computing, Computer Science, Game Design, Internet of Things, Programming, Web and Digital Design, and Web Development pathways. Pathway name(s) offered at Denmark High School: Computer Science and Cloud Computing
Career Opportunities:	Students who continue in a pathway that begins with this course may pursue careers such as software developer, web developer, web and digital designer, UX/UI designer, game developer, computer programmer, cybersecurity analyst, cloud computing technician, Internet of Things (IoT) technician, IT support specialist, and computer and information technology manager.

End of Pathway Assessment (EOPA):	Introduction to Software Technology is the first course in its pathways, so students do not take the EOPA in this course. Students who complete a pathway that begins with this course take the End of Pathway Assessment (EOPA) in the final course of that pathway. EOPA for Denmark High School pathway(s): [INSERT EOPA NAME(S)]
Course Text(s) and Resources:	

Projected Course Timeline		
Unit	**Approximate Timeline**	**Major Assignments**
Semester 1		
1	**3.5 weeks**	**Digital Citizenship and Cyber Hygiene** **2 quizzes, 1 test, 1 project**
2	**2 weeks**	**Computing Basics** **2 quizzes, 1 test**
3	**3 weeks**	**Operating Systems and Software** **2 quizzes, 1 test, 1 project**
4	**3 weeks**	**Web Design: HTML** **2 quizzes, 1 test, 1 project**
5	**3 weeks**	**Web Design: CSS** **2 quizzes, 1 test, 1 project**
Semester 2		
6	**3.5 weeks**	**Responsive Design** **2 quizzes, 1 project**
7	**2 weeks**	**Programming with Karel** **1 quiz**
8	**6 weeks**	**JavaScript Basics and Graphics** **3 quizzes, 1 test, 1 project**
9	**4 weeks**	**Web Development** **2 quizzes, 1 test, 1 project**
10	**2 weeks**	**Capstone Project**

Access this course in Canvas for the most up-to-date course information, including ancillary materials and key dates.

Assessment & Grading

Assessment Categories
• **Formative Assessments** include, but are not limited to, homework, class work, labs, investigations, practice tests, rough drafts, and sections of projects/research papers/presentations. • **Summative Assessments** include, but are not limited to, unit tests, final projects, final essays, formal lab reports, final research papers, and final presentations.

Grading Scale (FCS System & Class)	Grading Weights	Grading Calculations
A = 90-100 **B = 80-89** **C = 70-79** **F = 0-69**	Formative = 25% + Summative = 75% *(midterm and final exam multiplier=1)*	50% (Semester 1) + 50% (Semester 2) = Course Average

Final Exam Exemption: Students may exempt the final exam if they have a 90 or above course average.

Make-up Work

Make-up work is defined as work assigned during a student's absence, not work assigned prior to an absence. Students who are absent from school have five (5) school days upon returning to school to complete makeup work. The teacher has discretion to grant a longer period of time to make up the work if there are extenuating circumstances.

Summative Reassessment

To support continued learning, students may engage in one summative reassessment opportunity per semester per course.

Procedures:

- All formative assessments must be complete before a student takes a corresponding summative reassessment.
- The student must engage in re-teaching activities prior to the summative reassessment.
- The teacher collaborative team can determine one of two methods for reassessment:
  - Engage the student in re-teaching activities and reassess the standards.
  - Engage the student in re-teaching activities and use the midterm or final exam to reassess the aligned standards.
- To ensure accuracy in grading and reporting practices, full credit is applied to all reassessments.
- When a student does not show minimal proficiency of standards on multiple summative assessments, a multi-tiered system of supports will be put in place to assist the student in reaching proficiency.

Student Responsibilities

Academic Integrity

It is the expectation of Forsyth County Schools that students exhibit academic integrity when submitting evidence of learning. When students submit evidence that does not authentically represent what they know and can do, the evidence is rendered invalid. Examples of academic dishonesty are outlined in both the Family Engagement Guide & Student Handbook and The Forsyth County Schools Code of Conduct. Depending on the severity of the situation, academic dishonesty/cheating may result in the loss of credit, completing an alternative assignment and/or disciplinary consequences up to a tribunal referral.

Consequences for High School Students:

- First Offense: Parent contact + academic integrity contract + take a different assessment with a maximum assessment score of up to 60%
- Second Offense: Parent contact + loss of credit up to 100% + removal from honor clubs/societies + possible in-school suspension or out-of-school suspension
- Third Offense: Parent conference + loss of credit up to 100% + possible out-of-school suspension
- Academic Integrity offenses will not reset each school year. For example: If a student has an academic integrity offense during 9th grade and another one in 10th grade, the offense in 10th grade would be considered their second overall offense.
- Standardized Assessments: Any suspicion or instances of cheating on standardized tests will be reported to the governing agency and, based on the severity of the behavior, will receive disciplinary consequences.
- Severe Offenses: Should a student engage in behavior that compromises the integrity of an assessment (i.e., theft of assessment, pictures/dissemination of content, etc.), immediate and more severe consequences (up to a disciplinary tribunal) may be applied.

**Students who face consequences for submitting work that does not reflect their own knowledge and skills may only reassess in accordance with the FCS Academic Integrity Consequences for High School Students outlined above.*

Responsible Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence refers to computer systems that are trained with data to accomplish tasks normally requiring human intelligence. AI is used across industries and communities and can serve as a helpful tool in educational settings. Students should learn how to evaluate if and when they should use AI and develop responsible and ethical practices when using AI tools. Students with Forsyth County Schools are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic integrity. This includes the responsible use of emerging technologies such as artificial intelligence.

Students will:

- Use approved age-appropriate AI tools for educational purposes only
- Follow teacher guidance on the use of AI tools
- Submit work that is fundamentally my own and provide proper citations when AI is used
- Evaluate the purpose, safety, and the trustworthiness of AI tools before use
- Review and critically assess output of AI tools recognizing that AI may contain bias and inaccuracies
- Not use AI tools to propagate harmful, misleading, offensive or inappropriate content

All members of Forsyth County Schools' community agree to follow the **Forsyth County Schools Code of Conduct**, school rules and commit to these responsible use guidelines.

School/Content Team Information

Employability Skills: Standard 1 in all CTAE courses demonstrates the employability skills required by business and industry. This includes communication, demonstrating creativity, exhibiting critical thinking and problemsolving skills, modeling work readiness traits required for success in the workplace, and applying the appropriate skill sets to be productive in the workplace. Standard 1 also places emphasis on presenting a professional image through appearance, behavior, and language.

CTSO Affiliation (Career Tech Student Organizations): CTSOs are co-curricular organizations with leadership programs and competitive events which reflect current curriculum standards and competencies for the instructional programs they serve. Teachers infuse CTSO activities into the instructional activities, thereby helping students see the real-world value of their academic studies. The CTSO for this course appears below, and students are encouraged to take advantage of these additional leadership opportunities.

FBLA: The mission of Georgia FBLA is to bring business and education together in a positive working relationship through innovative leadership and career development programs.

Parent/Guardian Acknowledgment

I, _____, have read this course syllabus and approve of its contents. I agree to allow my student to use each of the classroom resources listed in the learning resource section. I will support my student in following the classroom expectations outlined in this course syllabus. I agree that I am the person who is legally allowed to consent for my student, whose name is listed below.

Student Name (Print):	
Parent/Guardian Name (Print):	

Parent/Guardian Signature:	
Date:	